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Comparing and Ordering Fractions

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Comparing and Ordering Fractions

These numbers are arranged from least to greatest: 2, 3, 4, 5

These fractions are arranged from least to greatest: $\frac{1}{5}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{2}$

$$= \frac{24}{120}, \frac{30}{120}, \frac{40}{120}, \frac{60}{120}$$

↙

$$\frac{1 \times 4 \times 3 \times 2}{5 \times 4 \times 3 \times 2}$$

↘

$$\frac{1 \times 4 \times 3 \times 2}{5 \times 4 \times 3 \times 2}$$

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Category

Lesson 4: Fraction Basics

Example 2:

Write the fractions in order from smallest to largest.

$$\frac{2}{5}, \frac{2}{3}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\text{common denominator} = 2 \times 3 \times 4 \times 5 \\ = 120$$

so fractions are

$$\frac{2 \times (2 \times 3 \times 4)}{5 \times (2 \times 3 \times 4)}, \frac{2 \times (2 \times 4 \times 5)}{3 \times (2 \times 4 \times 5)}, \frac{1 \times (2 \times 3 \times 5)}{4 \times (2 \times 3 \times 5)},$$

$$\frac{1 \times (3 \times 4 \times 5)}{2 \times (3 \times 4 \times 5)}$$

$$\frac{48}{120}, \frac{80}{120}, \frac{30}{120}, \frac{60}{120}$$

$$\text{so reorder: } \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{2}{5}, \frac{2}{3}$$